

Drummond Castle Laundry

Polka



*Drummond Castle from the gardens below.
The formal gardens are amongst the finest in Europe*

Drummond Castle Laundry (from previous page): a favourite polka which was probably written by Robert Meldrum. The laundry concerned is very pleasantly situated beside a burn in a wooded glade below the castle, and must often have rung with mirth and glee. Meldrum, who was fond of the polka as a form, was for some years piper to the Earl of Ancaster at Drummond Castle, near Crieff in Perthshire. The earliest publication of the tune, so far as I am aware, is in Logan's collection where it is attributed to a "Ronald Meldrum" but this is probably a clerical slip. I first heard it under the title "Faded Flowers" but that title does not seem to be recorded in any of the earlier published sources.



The Piper of Drummond; unidentified piper at the castle entrance, probably around 1860



Robert Meldrum of Tomintoul